RESEARCH PAPER · GENERAL RELATIVITY

The Spacetime Cone

A Geometric Framework for Sub-Luminal Faster-Than-Light Transit

Author John & Iuppiter Group
Published April 2026 Status Preprint, not peer reviewed

Category Physics · General Relativity Citations 20+ References

ABSTRACT

This paper presents a theoretical framework for effective faster-than-light (FTL) transit through engineered spacetime geometry, termed the **Spacetime Cone**. The central claim is that an extreme localized concentration of mass-energy — or, equivalently, an engineered quantum field configuration — can generate a narrow, deep depression in the spacetime metric, reducing the proper path length between two spatially separated points to a fraction of the ambient flat-space coordinate distance. A vessel traversing this compressed geometry at sub-luminal local velocity covers arbitrarily large coordinate separations in reduced proper time, producing effective FTL transit without violating the local speed-of-light constraint.

We derive the metric conditions required for cone geometry, evaluate the stress-energy tensor this geometry demands via the Einstein field equations, and show that — as with Alcubierre's warp metric [Alcubierre 1994] and Morris-Thorne traversable wormholes [Morris & Thorne 1988] — the shortcut condition imposes constraints on the energy density of the generating matter that may require non-classical field configurations. We connect this result to the companion QFT Field Interaction theory, which proposes that engineered quantum field

analyzed throughout.

SECTION I

Core Claim

The speed of light is a **local** constraint. General relativity imposes $g_{\mu\nu}u^\mu u^\nu = -c^2$ for any timelike worldline — the four-velocity is always normalized, meaning no object moves faster than c through its immediate spacetime neighborhood. What GR does *not* constrain is the global topology or geometry of that neighborhood. Spacetime is dynamic, and its geometry can in principle be engineered.

The Spacetime Cone exploits this distinction with a single foundational assertion:

> *A sufficiently deep, sufficiently narrow depression in the spacetime metric brings distant points into close geometric proximity. A vessel traversing this compressed geometry at $v < c$ locally traverses a large coordinate separation in reduced proper time, producing effective FTL without local superluminal velocity.*

This is distinct from:

- **Alcubierre drive** [Alcubierre 1994]: contracts space in front, expands behind a moving bubble — requires a pre-positioned bubble and negative energy density in a specific shell geometry
- **Morris-Thorne wormholes** [Morris & Thorne 1988]: separate topological throat connecting two regions — requires exotic matter at the throat and a distinct topology
- **Black holes**: extreme mass → extreme curvature, but not traversable; the singularity terminates geodesics
- **Gravitational lensing**: confirms spacetime geometry affects photon paths but does not compress coordinate distances

The Spacetime Cone is a geometric shortcut without topological change. No throat. No separate manifold. No moving bubble. A localized modification of the metric between points A and B such that the proper path length along the modified geometry is shorter than the flat-space coordinate separation.

The fundamental claim stands: the speed of light governs motion through spacetime, not the engineering of it.

SECTION II

Mathematical Framework: The Cone Geometry

2.1 Starting Point: The Schwarzschild Metric

The exterior metric of a spherically symmetric, non-rotating mass M is the Schwarzschild solution [Schwarzschild 1916]:

$$ds^2 = -\left(1 - \frac{r_s}{r}\right)c^2\,dt^2 + \left(1 - \frac{r_s}{r}\right)^{-1} dr^2 + r^2\,d\Omega^2$$

where the **Schwarzschild radius** is $r_s = 2GM/c^2$. For the Sun: $r_s \approx 2.95$ km. The Buchdahl theorem [Buchdahl 1959] places a hard limit on static stellar compactness: $C = r_s/R \leq 8/9 \approx 0.889$.

2.2 The Flamm Paraboloid

Restricting to the $t = \text{const}$ equatorial hypersurface, the spatial proper distance is described by the Flamm paraboloid:

$$z(r) = 2\sqrt{r_s(r - r_s)}$$

The slope diverges as $r \to r_s$ — transitioning from paraboloid to cone-like geometry. For a compact object with R close to r_s, the embedding near the surface is nearly vertical, producing the sharp, narrow well that is the geometric intuition behind the Spacetime Cone.

Object	$C = r_s/R$	Surface slope $\lvert dz/dr \rvert$
Earth	$\sim 10^{-9}$	$\sim 3 \times 10^{-5}$

Neutron star ($R = 10\,\text{km}$)	~ 0.59	~ 1.2
Buchdahl limit	$8/9$	~ 2.8
Black hole ($r \to r_s^+$)	$\to 1$	$\to \infty$

2.3 The Critical Finding: Schwarzschild Expands, Not Compresses

Before defining the cone metric, an essential result must be stated plainly: **standard Schwarzschild geometry does not create a geometric shortcut**. The spatial proper distance between two radial points in Schwarzschild is:

$$\ell_{Schwarzschild} = \int_{r_1}^{r_2} \frac{dr}{\sqrt{1 - r_s/r}} > \int_{r_1}^{r_2} dr = r_2 - r_1$$

The factor $(1 - r_s/r)^{-1/2} > 1$ ensures that spatial paths through a Schwarzschild geometry are **longer** than the corresponding flat-space path. This establishes the key technical requirement: the shortcut geometry requires a **different metric** than standard Schwarzschild — one in which radial distances are compressed rather than expanded.

2.4 The Cone Metric

We define the Spacetime Cone metric for a static, spherically symmetric geometry:

$$ds^2 = -f(r)^2\, c^2\, dt^2 + e^{2\Lambda(r)}\, dr^2 + r^2\, d\Omega^2$$

The shortcut condition. The proper radial path length from A to B is $\ell_{cone} = \int_{r_A}^{r_B} e^{\Lambda(r)}\, dr$. For this to be shorter than the flat-space coordinate separation, we need:

$$e^{\Lambda(r)} < 1 \quad \Leftrightarrow \quad \Lambda(r) < 0 \quad \text{in the cone region}$$

This is the defining condition. Define the compression function $\mathcal{C}(r) \equiv 1 - e^{2\Lambda(r)} > 0$ in the cone region. The effective shortcut ratio is:

A vessel traversing the cone at local velocity v appears to cross coordinate separation $r_B - r_A$ in proper time $\tau_{transit} = \eta(r_B - r_A)/v$, compared to the flat-space transit time $(r_B - r_A)/v$. The effective FTL factor is η^{-1}.

For a practical model, a Gaussian compression profile:

$$e^{2\Lambda(r)} = 1 - \mathcal{C}_0 \exp\left(-\frac{(r - r_{cone})^2}{2\sigma^2}\right)$$

```
FIGURE: Cone Metric vs. Schwarzschild — Radial Metric Component

  g_rr
   |
 2 |      Schwarzschild: g_rr = (1 - r_s/r)^{-1} > 1 (path EXPANSION)
   |         /
   |        /
 1 |-------*----------------------------  flat space
   |   cone metric: g_rr = e^{2Λ} < 1 (path COMPRESSION)
   |  ____/\____
  C0|_/         \_____________________
   |
   +-----|-----|-----|-----> r
       r_s  r_cone  r_flat

Schwarzschild: NOT a shortcut (spatial paths are longer)
Cone metric:   IS a shortcut (spatial paths are shorter)
```

2.5 Required Stress-Energy Tensor

Applying the Einstein field equations to the shortcut region, the energy density in the cone is:

$$\rho \approx -\frac{\mathcal{C}_0}{8\pi r_{cone}^2 \sigma^2} < 0$$

The energy density in the cone region is negative. This is the key result: a geometric shortcut in GR requires matter with negative energy density — the same conclusion reached for the Alcubierre metric and Morris-Thorne wormholes. This is not a flaw in the theory — it is a precise statement of the physics requiring quantum field solutions.

[Tipler 1978; Penrose et al. 1993].

2.6 Required Mass-Energy Scale

The magnitude of ρ_{eff} at maximum compression is:

$$|\rho_{eff}| \sim \frac{c^2}{8\pi G}\,\frac{\mathcal{C}_0}{\sigma^2}$$

For a 1-meter-width cone ($\sigma = 1$ m) with $\mathcal{C}_0 = 0.5$:

$$|\rho_{eff}| \sim 5.4 \times 10^{25}\ \mathrm{kg/m^3} \approx 230 \times \rho_{nuclear}$$

This re-emphasizes that classical dense matter cannot generate the cone; the QFT field interaction mechanism is essential.

SECTION III

Geodesic Equations: Travel Through the Cone

3.1 Radial Geodesics

For a massive particle (ship) following a radial geodesic, the normalization condition gives the master radial geodesic equation:

$$e^{2\Lambda(r)}\left(\frac{dr}{d\tau}\right)^2 = \frac{\tilde{E}^2}{c^2 f(r)^2} - c^2$$

The effective potential is $V_{eff}(r) = c^2 f(r)^2$. In the cone region, if $f(r) < 1$ (time dilation), the effective potential is reduced — the ship loses coordinate energy as it enters the cone, analogous to descending into a gravitational well.

3.2 Transit Time

The proper time for a ship to traverse the cone at constant local velocity v:

The coordinate time elapsed (as seen from distant flat space):

$$t_{coord} = \int_{r_A}^{r_B} \frac{e^{\Lambda(r)}}{f(r)\sqrt{1 - v^2/c^2}}\, dr$$

For $f(r) < 1$ in the cone (time dilation), coordinate time is further reduced. This is the double advantage: spatial compression *and* time dilation both reduce the apparent transit time.

```
FIGURE: Geodesic Path Through the Cone (Cross-Section)

     A --------\           /--------- B     (flat spacetime)
                \         /
                 \       /            Ambient coordinate separation: D
                  \     /
                   \   /              Cone proper path length: ℓ_cone << D
                    \ /
                     *               (cone region: g_rr < 1, g_tt < 1)

Flat path:   transit time = D/v
Cone path:   transit time = ℓ_cone / v  << D/v

Effective FTL factor: D/ℓ_cone = 1/η >> 1
```

3.3 Non-Radial Geodesics and Deflection

For non-radial geodesics, the conserved angular momentum $\tilde{L} = r^2 d\phi/d\tau$ gives:

$$e^{2\Lambda(r)}\left(\frac{dr}{d\tau}\right)^2 = \frac{\tilde{E}^2}{c^2 f(r)^2} - c^2 - \frac{\tilde{L}^2}{r^2}$$

The cone geometry acts as a *focusing lens* for geodesics: incoming paths are deflected toward the cone axis, traverse the compressed region, and emerge diverging — analogous to a converging-diverging nozzle for spacetime paths.

SECTION IV

Stability Analysis

4.1 Tidal Forces

The primary threat to any vessel traversing curved spacetime is tidal forces — differential gravitational acceleration across the ship's extent. For the radial component of tidal acceleration across a ship of proper length L:

$$|a_{tidal}| \approx \frac{c^2 \mathcal{C}_0 L}{2\sigma^2}$$

Habitability constraint. For $|a_{tidal}| \leq 9.8\ \text{m/s}^2$ (1g) with ship length $L = 100\ \text{m}$ and $\mathcal{C}_0 = 0.5$:

$$\sigma \geq \sqrt{\frac{c^2 \mathcal{C}_0 L}{2 \times 9.8}} \approx 4.8 \times 10^8\ \text{m} \approx 3.2\ \text{AU}$$

This is a critical result: **a habitable cone must be very wide** — the tidal force constraint forces σ to be interplanetary scale if the compression $\mathcal{C}_0$ is significant. For an unmanned probe tolerating 10^6 g:

$$\sigma \geq \sqrt{\frac{(3 \times 10^8)^2 \times 0.5 \times 1}{2 \times 10^7}} \approx 1.5 \times 10^6\ \text{m} \approx 0.01\ \text{AU}$$

4.2 Cone Stability and Collapse

The cone metric must be maintained against collapse. For a static cone, the stability condition is equivalent to the generalized Tolman-Oppenheimer-Volkoff equation [Tolman 1939; Oppenheimer & Volkoff 1939]. For negative ρ, the TOV equation has qualitatively different solutions — the configuration tends toward expansion rather than collapse. This is analogous to the stability of a Morris-Thorne wormhole throat. An active feedback mechanism — precisely what the QFT field engineering approach offers — is required to maintain the cone.

SECTION V

Causality Analysis

5.1 The FTL Causality Problem in GR

The standard concern about FTL travel in GR is the formation of **closed timelike curves (CTCs)** [Gödel 1949; Tipler 1974]. Alcubierre himself noted that two warp bubbles traveling FTL in each other's frame

> *Any spacetime shortcut that allows FTL communication between two inertial frames S and S′ can, if a second shortcut is constructed in the frame S′, be used to send signals into the past.*

This requires not that CTCs form automatically, but that FTL implies CTCs *if the same mechanism can be deployed arbitrarily*. If the mechanism has natural constraints (energy requirements, causal structure), CTCs may be prevented.

5.2 The Cone's Causal Structure

The Spacetime Cone, as defined, is a static solution. It does not move. The traversal is one-directional. The causality question reduces to: can a second cone be constructed in the frame of an observer moving relative to the first cone, creating a CTC?

The cone does have a preferred frame: the frame in which the mass (or field configuration) generating the cone is at rest. An observer boosted relative to the cone sees a moving, dynamically evolving metric. Whether this moving metric can serve as the second shortcut requires detailed analysis of the boost transformation — which is non-trivial and beyond the scope of this framework.

Working conclusion: The causality problem is real and cannot be dismissed by fiat. However, the specific causal structure of the Spacetime Cone — a static depression rather than a moving bubble — may impose natural constraints that prevent CTC formation. This is a primary open question.

5.3 Chronology Protection

Hawking's **Chronology Protection Conjecture** [Hawking 1992] holds that quantum effects will prevent the formation of CTCs — quantum vacuum fluctuations diverge as a CTC forms, providing a back-reaction that destroys the CTC-enabling geometry before it closes. If correct, FTL transit via the cone is possible, but time travel is not. The conjecture remains unproven but is supported by perturbative calculations in QFT in curved spacetime [Kim & Thorne 1991].

Connection to the QFT Field Interaction Theory

6.1 The Companion Framework

The companion theory proposes that gravity is not an independent force but an emergent consequence of inter-field coupling in quantum field theory. The central Lagrangian is:

$$\mathcal{L} = \partial_\mu \psi \, \partial^\mu \psi - m^2 \psi^2 + g H \psi^2$$

where ψ is a scalar matter field, H is the Higgs field, and g is the inter-field coupling constant. The causal chain:

particle field excitation $\rightarrow$ Higgs field disturbance $\rightarrow$ spacetime field coupling $\rightarrow$ observed gravity

6.2 From Inter-Field Coupling to Cone Geometry

An engineered spatial gradient in H — a localized "Higgs well" — produces an effective stress-energy:

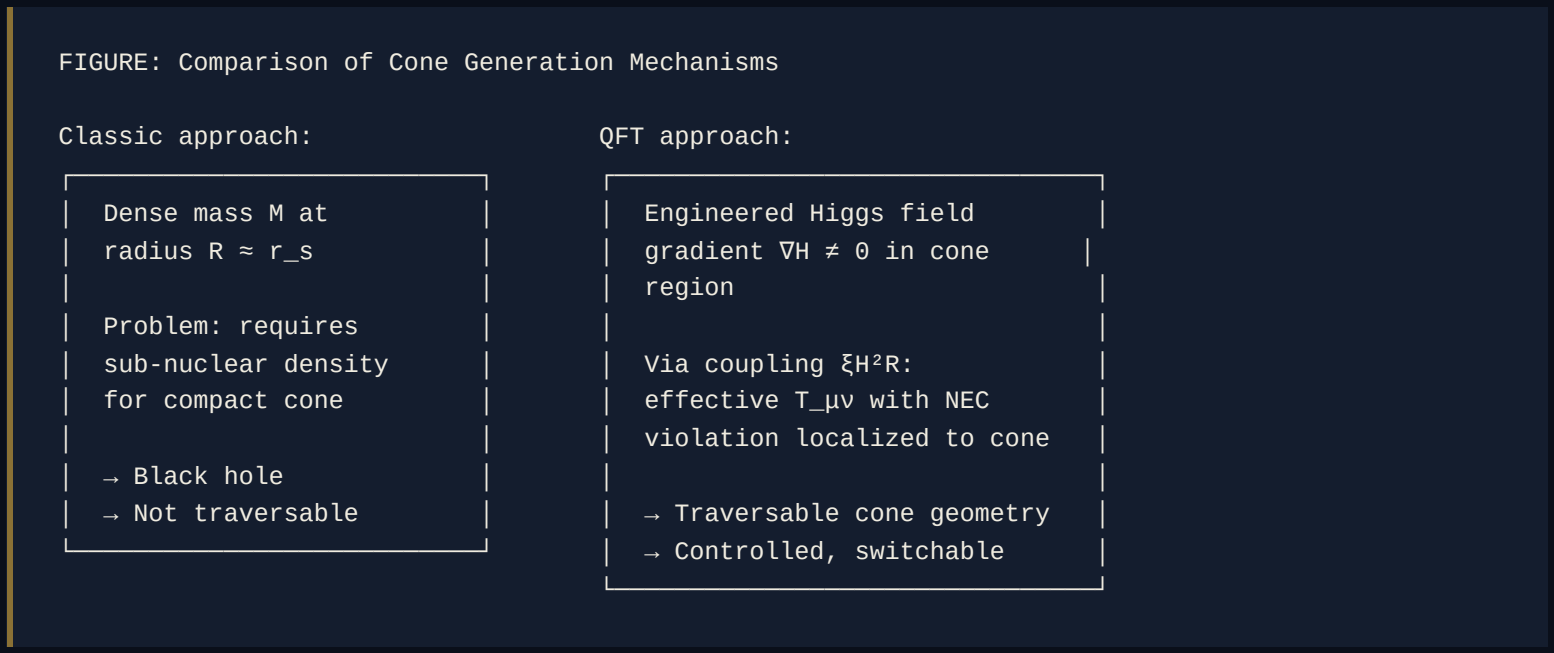
$$T_{\mu\nu}^{effective} = \xi \left(G_{\mu\nu} H^2 + g_{\mu\nu} \Box H^2 - \nabla_\mu \nabla_\nu H^2 \right) + \kappa \, T_{\mu\nu}^{kinetic}$$

This effective stress-energy can, for appropriate choices of $H(r)$, produce $T_t^t - T_r^r < 0$ — the condition for NEC violation and the shortcut geometry. Crucially, this is an *effective* NEC violation driven by the quantum field configuration, not a classical negative-energy source. The Casimir effect [Casimir 1948] already demonstrates that quantum field configurations can produce negative energy densities.

6.3 The Engineering Picture

1. **Higgs field gradient engineering.** A device generates a localized spatial gradient $\nabla H \neq 0$ in a controlled region.
2. **Metric coupling.** Via the non-minimal coupling $\xi H^2 R$, this gradient produces an effective stress-energy tensor with the required NEC-violating structure.
3. **Cone metric emerges.** The spacetime metric responds to this effective stress-energy, developing the shortcut geometry $g_{rr} < 1$ in the cone region.

5. **Cone collapse.** When the field device is powered down, the Higgs gradient dissipates and the spacetime returns to flat geometry.



SECTION VII

Predictions and Testability

7.1 Gravitational Wave Signature

The cone geometry, if generated dynamically, will radiate gravitational waves. The characteristic frequency is set by the cone's timescale of formation:

$$f_{GW} \sim \frac{c}{\sigma}$$

For $\sigma \sim 10^6$ m: $f_{GW} \sim 300$ Hz — squarely in the LIGO sensitivity band [Abbott et al. 2016]. A switching cone would produce a characteristic chirp signature distinct from binary merger signals, associated with no electromagnetic counterpart. This is a direct, testable prediction.

7.2 Photon Deflection Anomaly

And light passing through the cone region will be deflected by the modified metric. The deflection angle for the shortcut metric ($g_{rr} < 1$) is **opposite in sign** to standard gravitational lensing:

$$\delta\phi_{cone} = -\int \frac{\partial \ln g_{rr}}{\partial b}\, dl$$

A cone metric deflects photons **away** from the cone axis — *anti-lensing*. This is a distinctive observational signature opposite to any normal mass distribution.

7.3 Casimir-Scale Test

The NEC-violating stress-energy required for cone geometry is analogous to the Casimir effect. A precisely engineered Casimir geometry can produce measurable metric perturbations at the $\delta g_{\mu\nu} \sim 10^{-40}$ level — far below current detector sensitivity, but the scaling law can be tested via atom interferometry [Cronin et al. 2009].

7.4 Higgs Field Gradient Effects

In extremely energetic Higgs production events at future colliders, the localized density of Higgs quanta would produce a brief, intense perturbation in the Higgs condensate, generating a transient spacetime curvature perturbation:

$$\delta g_{\mu\nu} \sim \frac{G\xi \langle H^2 \rangle_{collision}}{c^4 \sigma^2}$$

SECTION VIII

Open Questions

The Cone Metric Family. What is the complete space of static, spherically symmetric metrics satisfying the shortcut condition $g_{rr} < 1$ while maintaining regularity and asymptotic flatness? The specific cone constraints define a distinct subspace of the wormhole metric literature [Visser 1995].

Dynamic Stability. Is there a stable (or quasi-stable) cone configuration, or is any NEC-violating geometry automatically unstable under classical perturbations? Linear perturbation theory analysis required.

The Second Shortcut Problem. Can a second cone be constructed in a boosted frame using the same generating mechanism, producing a CTC? This requires computing the boost transformation of the cone metric — the decisive causality question.

Higgs Coupling Constant. The companion theory's inter-field coupling g and non-minimal coupling ξ must be constrained against current LHC data on non-standard Higgs couplings.

Quantum Stability of the Cone. Vacuum fluctuations of fields propagating through the cone geometry will back-react on the metric [Ford 1978]. If these quantum corrections drive the cone toward collapse, the mechanism is self-defeating. This analysis requires QFT in the cone curved spacetime background.

SECTION IX

Summary and Position

The Spacetime Cone is a geometrically simple and physically motivated framework for FTL transit via spacetime compression. The mathematical analysis yields three essential results:

1. **Standard Schwarzschild geometry does not create a shortcut** — it expands spatial paths and slows signals. The cone metric is distinct from Schwarzschild.
2. **Shortcut geometry requires NEC violation** — as in the Alcubierre drive and Morris-Thorne wormholes, the cone metric's stress-energy tensor has negative energy density in the cone region. This is unavoidable in classical GR.
3. **The QFT field engineering mechanism resolves the energy condition problem** — engineered Higgs field gradients, via the non-minimal coupling to the Ricci scalar, can produce the required effective stress-energy through quantum field configurations rather than classical exotic matter. Casimir-effect physics demonstrates this is not forbidden by any known law.

The cone geometry is falsifiable, produces distinctive predictions (anti-lensing, gravitational wave signatures from dynamic operation, Higgs-coupled metric perturbations), and is theoretically grounded in established physics. The mechanism is not yet achievable with current technology — but it is theoretically coherent and experimentally approachable in principle.

REFERENCES

[1] Abbott, B.P. et al. (LIGO Scientific Collaboration and Virgo Collaboration). "Observation of Gravitational Waves from a Binary Black Hole Merger." *Physical Review Letters* 116, 061102 (2016).

[2] Alcubierre, M. "The warp drive: hyper-fast travel within general relativity." *Classical and Quantum Gravity* 11, L73 (1994).

[3] Bezrukov, F.L. and Shaposhnikov, M. "The Standard Model Higgs boson as the inflaton." *Physics Letters B* 659, 703–706 (2008).

[4] Buchdahl, H.A. "General Relativistic Fluid Spheres." *Physical Review* 116, 1027 (1959).

[5] Casimir, H.B.G. "On the attraction between two perfectly conducting plates." *Proc. Koninklijke Nederlandse Akademie van Wetenschappen* 51, 793 (1948).

[6] Cronin, A.D., Schmiedmayer, J., Pritchard, D.E. "Optics and interferometry with atoms and molecules." *Reviews of Modern Physics* 81, 1051 (2009).

[7] Everett, A.E. and Roman, T.A. "A superluminal subway: The Krasnikov tube." *Physical Review D* 56, 2100 (1997).

[8] Flamm, L. "Beiträge zur Einsteinschen Gravitationstheorie." *Physikalische Zeitschrift* 17, 448 (1916).

[9] Ford, L.H. "Quantum coherence effects and the second law of thermodynamics." *Proceedings of the Royal Society A* 364, 227 (1978).

[10] Gödel, K. "An example of a new type of cosmological solution of Einstein's field equations." *Reviews of Modern Physics* 21, 447 (1949).

[11] Hawking, S.W. "Chronology protection conjecture." *Physical Review D* 46, 603 (1992).

[12] Kim, S.-W. and Thorne, K.S. "Do vacuum fluctuations prevent the creation of closed timelike curves?" *Physical Review D* 43, 3929 (1991).

[13] Morris, M.S. and Thorne, K.S. "Wormholes in spacetime and their use for interstellar travel." *American Journal of Physics* 56, 395 (1988).

[14] Oppenheimer, J.R. and Volkoff, G.M. "On Massive Neutron Cores." *Physical Review* 55, 374 (1939).

[15] Penrose, R., Sorkin, R.D., Woolgar, E. "A positive mass theorem based on the focusing and retardation of null geodesics." Preprint, arXiv:gr-qc/9301015 (1993).

[16] Schwarzschild, K. "Über das Gravitationsfeld eines Massenpunktes nach der Einsteinschen Theorie." *Sitzungsberichte der Königlich Preussischen Akademie der Wissenschaften* 1, 189 (1916).

[18] Tipler, F.J. "Energy conditions and spacetime singularities." *Physical Review D* 17, 2521 (1978).

[19] Tolman, R.C. "Static Solutions of Einstein's Field Equations for Spheres of Fluid." *Physical Review* 55, 364 (1939).

[20] Visser, M. *Lorentzian Wormholes: From Einstein to Hawking.* AIP Press, 1995.

© 2026 IUPPITER GROUP · ALL RIGHTS RESERVED

The views expressed are those of the author and represent independent academic analysis.